

1.1 The Motherboard

1.1.1 Audio sockets

A set of sockets that allowed speakers and a microphone to be connected, usually three in number. With multi-channel audio becoming common, the number of sockets has risen to six. The function of each of these sockets is configurable from the audio driver.

1.1.2 AGP

The Accelerated Graphics Port is present only in very few new motherboards; it is being phased out. This was a slot dedicated to enhance the graphics capabilities of the system by allowing a high-speed direct bus to the RAM, unlike PCI, the other prevalent bus. (A bus refers to a channel that is used to transfer data.) It operated at 66 MHz and had a 32-bit width. The AGP specifications have passed through three revisions (AGP 1, 2, and



Screenshot 1: 1.5 V AGP slot.jpeg



Screenshot 2: 3.3 V AGP slot.jpeg

3). The original AGP specification, now referred to as AGP 1, specified only 1X and 2X speeds. It also mandated an AGP slot that provided 3.3 V. AGP2 extended support to the 4X mode of operation. It also specified an AGP slot that provided 1.5 V, but AGP2 cards could work in the older AGP1 slots. To maintain backward compatibility to AGP1 cards, a Universal AGP Slot allowed cards of both versions to be run in it. AGP3 supported speeds up to 8X and would only work in slots that operated at 1.5 V.

The AGP slots differed in the construction, so that 3.3 V and 1.5 V slots and cards were not compatible: the 3.3 V AGP slot has a par-